



Workplace Health and Safety

Module Code: WHS01 | 3 Credits | 30 Learning Hours

Module Overview

Module Code

WHS01

Credits

03

Learning Hours

30

Contact Hours

15

This module provides comprehensive training in workplace health and safety principles, combining theoretical knowledge with practical application.



Delivery Methods



Lectures

Provides holistic approach to topics, focusing on key theories and models with application in group and organisational settings.



Seminars

Combined business concept seminars facilitated by lecturers, exploring broad range of business issues through discussion and analysis.



Tutorials

Active and participative learning approaches to explore concepts in detail, demonstrate theory in action, and develop skills.

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, trainees will be able to:

01

Key Concepts & Roles

Understand WHS concepts and roles of different people in workplace safety.

02

Laws & Compliance

Learn WHS laws, regulations, and standards for legal compliance.

03

Hazard Identification

Identify workplace hazards and perform risk assessments.

04

Risk Control

Use hierarchy of controls to reduce risks and prevent incidents.

05

PPE Knowledge

Understand PPE selection, use, and effectiveness.

Learning Outcome 1: Key Concepts & Roles

Understanding Workplace Safety

Grasp fundamental concepts of Workplace Health and Safety and recognise the critical roles different stakeholders play in maintaining safe and healthy work environments.

- Key WHS concepts and terminology
- Roles and responsibilities in workplace safety
- Importance of collaboration in safety





Learning Outcome 2: Laws & Compliance

WHS Laws & Regulations

Comprehensive understanding of legal frameworks governing workplace health and safety.

Standards & Guidelines

Knowledge of industry standards and best practice guidelines for compliance.

Legal Compliance

Apply regulations to ensure compliance and avoid penalties in workplace settings.

Learning Outcome 3: Hazard Identification



Identifying & Assessing Risks

Develop ability to identify various workplace hazards and perform comprehensive risk assessments using appropriate tools and methods.

- Recognise different types of hazards
- Use assessment tools and methods
- Evaluate likelihood and severity
- Document findings effectively

Learning Outcome 4: Risk Control



Elimination

Remove the hazard entirely from the workplace.



Substitution

Replace with less hazardous alternatives.



Engineering Controls

Isolate people from hazards through physical changes.



Administrative Controls

Change work practices and procedures.



PPE

Use personal protective equipment as last line of defence.

Create comprehensive plans to manage and prevent workplace incidents using the hierarchy of controls.

Learning Outcome 5: PPE Knowledge



Head Protection

Hard hats and helmets for impact protection.



Eye Protection

Goggles and safety glasses for chemical and debris protection.



Hand Protection

Gloves for chemical, thermal, and mechanical protection.



Foot Protection

Steel-toe boots for impact and puncture protection.

Understand how PPE reduces risks, know proper selection and use, and assess effectiveness in workplace safety.

Assessment Methods

1

Quiz on Key Concepts

20% - Controlled Assessment (LO1)

2

Worksheet on WHS Laws

15% - Controlled Assessment (LO2)

3

Hazard Identification Poster

20% - Uncontrolled Assessment (LO3)

4

Risk Control Plan Report

20% - Uncontrolled Assessment (LO4)

5

PPE Matching Activity

25% - Controlled Assessment (LO5)

Attendance Policy

- **Minimum attendance: 80%**
- **75–79% attendance** → student may apply for special consideration

Assessment Policy

- At least **50% of assessments in controlled conditions**
- Late Submission Penalties
- 5% deduction per day after the deadline
- Penalty applies including holidays
- Assignments more than 7 days late are not accepted

Introduction: The Silent Connection (3 Mins)



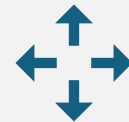
Find your matching number!



Rule #1: No talking, no whispering, no mouthing words.



Use hand signals, gestures, or "air writing" to find the person with the same number as you



Move to the side of the class together and stay silent until everyone is paired.

Introduction: The Interview (3 Mins)



Time to talk! Get to know your partner.



Ask your partner;

Name

From

**Employment or Work
Experience**

Course



Introduce your partner to the class.

Work Health and Safety (WHS)

Work Health and Safety (WHS), often called Occupational Health and Safety (OHS), refers to the laws and systems designed to protect the physical and mental health, safety, and welfare of everyone in a workplace.



What WHS Covers

It is not just about preventing physical accidents like falls; it also includes:

Physical Safety

Preventing hazards such as equipment injuries, chemical exposure, and noise.

Psychological Safety

Managing "psychosocial hazards" like workplace stress, bullying, and burnout.

Broad Coverage

The duty of care extends beyond employees to include contractors, customers, and visitors.

Global WHS Statistics (2025–2026)

Providing hard numbers can help the class understand the scale of the issue:

2.3M

Global Impact

The ILO estimates roughly 2.3 million workers die annually from work-related accidents or diseases.

\$176.5B

Financial Cost

In 2023, the total cost of work injuries in the U.S. alone reached \$176.5 billion, covering lost productivity, medical bills, and administrative fees.

High-Risk Sectors

80% of traumatic fatalities and 61% of serious claims consistently occur in six industries: Agriculture, Construction, Manufacturing, Transport, Health Care, and Public Safety.

The "Mental Health" Rise

Claims for mental health conditions now account for approximately 12% of all serious claims, often requiring five times as much time off as physical injuries.

Human Error

It is estimated that 80–90% of serious injuries are caused by preventable human error, which highlights the need for better training.

Group Work

Divide into two groups to discuss the benefits of Workplace Health and Safety for both **employees** and **employers**.

You have **20 minutes** for your group discussion, followed by a brief presentation of your findings to the class.

10 Minutes: Class Presentation (5 mins per group).

Importance of WHS





For the Employer

Legal Compliance

Prevents heavy fines, litigation, and even imprisonment for corporate negligence.

Lower Costs

Reduces workers' compensation premiums and costs related to equipment damage or recruitment for replacement staff.

Productivity

Healthy workers are more focused and efficient. Safety programs typically provide a return on investment (ROI) of \$2 to \$6 for every \$1 spent.

Reputation

Strong safety standards enhance brand value and help attract top talent.

For the Employee



Personal Well-being

Ensures workers return home safely and prevents long-term occupational diseases.

Job Satisfaction

Employees who feel safe have higher morale, greater loyalty, and lower stress levels.

Financial Stability

Prevents the loss of wages and the physical limitations that come with long-term disability.

Empowerment

Gives workers a "voice" to identify hazards and take responsibility for their own environment.



Key Stakeholders in Workplace Health and Safety

1. The Employer

The employer has the primary duty of care. They are responsible for the "big picture" of safety.

Key Roles:

Safe Environment

Providing a safe work environment and equipment.

Safe Systems

Ensuring safe systems of work (procedures).

Training & Support

Providing necessary training, information, and supervision.

Monitoring

Monitoring the health of workers and conditions of the workplace.



2. The Employee

Workers must take reasonable care for their own safety and the safety of those around them.

Key Roles:



Following Procedures

Following all safety instructions and procedures.



Using PPE Correctly

Using Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) correctly.



Reporting Issues

Reporting hazards, "near misses," or injuries immediately.



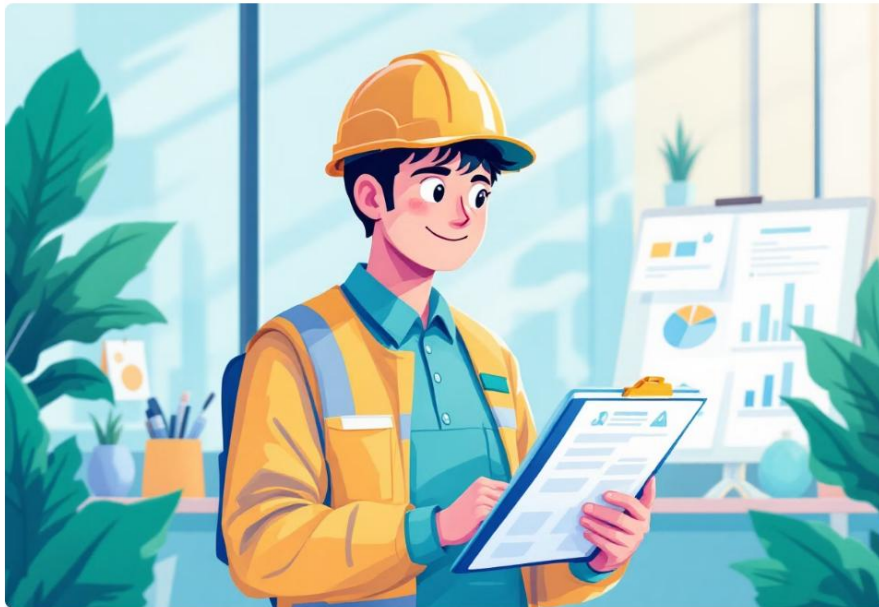
Respecting Safety Equipment

Not interfering with or misusing safety equipment.

3. The Regulator

Regulators (like SafeWork, OSHA) are government agencies that enforce the law.

Key Roles:



Enforcement

Conducting inspections and issuing fines or legal action for non-compliance.

Education

Providing advice, codes of practice, and resources to businesses.

Investigation

Looking into serious workplace incidents or fatalities.

Statistics

Tracking national data to identify high-risk industries.

Group Workshop: WHS Law



Instructions:



Divide into two groups.



Collaborate to identify and note the following key areas.



Prepare a brief summary to present during the **next class**.

WHS Laws in the Maldives: Focus on the Occupational Safety and Health Act (Act No. 2/2024) and the Employment Act (2/2008).

Rights and Responsibilities: What are workers entitled to (e.g., the right to refuse unsafe work)? What are the legal duties of the employer (e.g., providing PPE and training)?

Consequences of Non-Compliance: What happens when the law is broken? (Think about fines, stop-work orders, and compensation claims).